



The GLP-1 Coverage Checklist

If a GLP-1 for weight loss is out of reach on price, there are now **two real, legitimate paths** to get covered — a new \$50-a-month Medicare pilot, and your right to appeal a private-insurance denial. Here's exactly how to tell which one is yours, and what to do.

Read this first: the Medicare program below is a **temporary government pilot that runs through December 31, 2027** — *not* a new permanent Medicare benefit. Medicare still does not broadly cover weight-loss drugs by law; this pilot is a limited window that works around that. Use it while it's open, and don't assume it'll be there forever.

START HERE — which path is yours?

- ☐ **On Medicare (with Part D drug coverage)?** → Go to **Path A** (the \$50/month Bridge). For most eligible people it's the cheapest legitimate route — cheaper than an appeal, cheaper than cash. Check it first.
- ☐ **On Medicare but not eligible for the Bridge, or you want a drug it doesn't cover?** → Your denials go through the normal **Part D appeal** — see Path B; it works the same way.
- ☐ **Not on Medicare — private plan through work or the marketplace, and they denied your GLP-1?** → Go to **Path B** (the appeal).

PATH A The \$50/month Medicare GLP-1 Bridge

What it is

- ☐ A **temporary CMS pilot program** running **July 1, 2026 → December 31, 2027**.
- ☐ If you qualify, you pay a **flat \$50/month** for a covered GLP-1 — **at any income level**.

The honest fine print (know this going in)

- ☐ That \$50 **does not count** toward your Part D deductible or out-of-pocket maximum.
- ☐ There's **no extra low-income subsidy** stacked on top of it.
- ☐ It's **separate** from the Medicare Prescription Payment Plan.

Only these drugs are covered (get this exactly right)

- ✓ **Foundayo** (tablet)
- ✓ **Wegovy** (injection *or* tablet)
- ✓ **Zepbound — KwikPen version ONLY**

✗ **NOT covered:** Ozempic · compounded or generic semaglutide/tirzepatide · Zepbound **vials** or **single-dose pens** (must be the KwikPen).

Bring a non-covered version to the pharmacy and the \$50 price simply won't apply. Confirm the *exact* product with your prescriber.

Do you qualify? (all four must be true)

- ☐ 1. You have Medicare **Part D** drug coverage — the standard kind (**not** a Private Fee-for-Service, cost, or PACE plan).
- ☐ 2. You are **not already** getting a GLP-1 through your regular Part D.
- ☐ 3. You do **NOT** have **type-2 diabetes, moderate-to-severe sleep apnea, or fatty liver disease**. *This surprises people:* if you have one of these, your GLP-1 is handled through **normal Part D**, not this Bridge.
- ☐ 4. You meet a **BMI/health** threshold — broadly one of: BMI ≥ 35 ; or BMI ≥ 30 with heart failure, uncontrolled high blood pressure, or chronic kidney disease (stage 3a+); or BMI ≥ 27 with prediabetes or a prior heart attack, stroke, or peripheral artery disease. (*Your doctor confirms the exact clinical fit.*)

How to enroll (3 steps)

- ☐ 1. Talk to your prescriber and confirm you meet the criteria above.
- ☐ 2. Ask them to prescribe **one of the covered drugs** (Foundayo tablet, Wegovy, or Zepbound KwikPen).
- ☐ 3. Ask your **Part D plan** to run it through the **Medicare GLP-1 Bridge**, and confirm your copay comes back as **\$50**.
- ☐ Before you fill, **re-check the current covered-drug list** at Medicare.gov — the list can change.

PATH B You were denied (private plan or Part D): appeal it

Denials get overturned all the time, and you have the **right to appeal**. The steps are the same shape almost everywhere:

- ☐ 1. **Get the denial in writing** and read the exact reason (prior-auth required / "not medically necessary" / plan excludes weight-loss drugs / quantity or step-therapy limit / compounded-version denial). The reason decides your argument.
- ☐ 2. **Have your doctor submit a prior authorization** with the evidence insurers look for: your **BMI history**, related conditions, and prior treatments you've tried. Getting the PA right the first time resolves many denials without an appeal.
- ☐ 3. **If still denied, file a formal internal appeal** with your plan, in writing, before the deadline printed on your denial letter. (*Deadlines vary by plan — always follow the ones on your own letter.*)

- ❑ **4. If the internal appeal fails, request an external independent review** — an outside reviewer, not your insurer, decides. For most ACA/marketplace and employer plans this is your right; for Medicare it's the next level of the Part D appeal.
- ❑ **5. Keep every letter, date, and confirmation.** Your paper trail is your leverage.

Every rung here is yours by right. Most people never use it — that's exactly what the denial is counting on.

Copy-paste: hand this to your doctor's office

"I'd like to pursue a GLP-1 for weight management. Can we submit a prior authorization that documents my BMI history and related conditions? If it's denied, I intend to appeal, so please note the clinical criteria in the request. And if I'm on Medicare, can we check whether I qualify for the GLP-1 Bridge and which covered drug fits?"

Official sources (bookmark these)

- ✓ **Medicare GLP-1 Bridge (CMS):** cms.gov/medicare/coverage/prescription-drug-coverage/medicare-glp-1-bridge
- ✓ **Official fact sheet (PDF):** medicare.gov/publications/12234-medicare-glp-1-bridge-glp-1-drugs-for-50-a-month.pdf
- ✓ **Your plan:** the phone number and appeal address are on your insurance card and your denial letter.

If your denial is complicated — a plan exclusion, a step-therapy wall, or a compounded-drug denial — the full **GLP-1 Appeal Kit (\$39)** has fill-in appeal letters for each denial reason, a prior-auth worksheet for your doctor, and playbooks for the major insurers: moneyyoureowed.com/glp1-appeal (optional paid upgrade; everything in this free checklist you can do yourself).

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General educational information — **not medical, legal, or insurance advice**, and not a guarantee of coverage or approval. Program terms, eligibility, and the covered-drug list can change; always confirm the current details at **Medicare.gov** and with your own plan before you act. The Medicare GLP-1 Bridge is a temporary CMS pilot scheduled to end December 31, 2027.